

# Test 2 Key

## Reading and Use of English (1 hour 15 minutes)

### Part 1

1 D    2 B    3 A    4 B    5 D    6 C    7 A    8 D

### Part 2

9 the    10 enough    11 it    12 whose    13 with    14 to    15 As    16 put

### Part 3

17 intention    18 unwelcoming    19 citizens    20 satisfaction  
21 competitive    22 strength    23 response    24 childish

### Part 4

25 SHOULD be able / allowed | to come  
26 was | an INCREASE in  
27 the SUBJECT | every (single) / each  
28 at | your DISPOSAL  
29 has | (very/really) high EXPECTATIONS  
30 didn't / did not REALISE | what

### Part 5

31 A    32 C    33 D    34 B    35 B    36 C

### Part 6

37 E    38 A    39 G    40 C    41 F    42 B

### Part 7

43 D    44 A    45 B    46 A    47 C    48 A    49 C    50 B    51 C    52 D

## Writing (1 hour 20 minutes)

Candidate responses are marked using the assessment scale on page 107-108.

**Listening** (approximately 40 minutes)

*Part 1*

1 B    2 A    3 B    4 B    5 B    6 C    7 A    8 A

*Part 2*

9 documentary    10 beauty    11 comet    12 moons  
13 a space station    14 light (pollution)    15 (local) club  
16 rings    17 discoveries    18 discipline

*Part 3*

19 H    20 A    21 G    22 C    23 D

*Part 4*

24 B    25 C    26 A    27 C    28 C    29 B    30 C

**Transcript**

*This is the Cambridge English: First for Schools Listening Test. Test Two.*

*I'm going to give you the instructions for this test. I'll introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you'll hear this sound:*

*tone*

*You will hear each piece twice.*

*Remember, while you're listening, write your answers on the question paper. You'll have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.*

*There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.*

*[pause]*

*Now open your question paper and look at Part One.*

*[pause]*

Test 2 Key

PART 1

*You'll hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).*

*Question 1 You hear two friends talking about a lesson on the subject of newspapers.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: I enjoyed the discussion about newspapers. Having to do some research before the lesson meant we all knew what we had to discuss.

Boy: Yeah, but the discussion itself was a bit disorganised. We could've done with someone to lead it and make sure everyone had a chance to speak. We did get through a lot of topics though.

Girl: Everything from how newspapers deal with social media to the way they report on celebrities' private lives. I thought some people had some very interesting and different things to say.

Boy: Yeah, well, they talk as if they've got something new and amazing to tell you. I didn't hear anything I hadn't heard before, though.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*Question 2 You hear a man talking about skateboarders in the past.*

[pause]

tone

Man: I remember getting my first skateboard when I was 11. In those days skateboarders were generally seen as rebels who just did whatever they wanted without considering other people. So skateboarding was disapproved of by just about everyone, and people who did it liked to show off the fact that they were different. They had to practise in the streets because there weren't any specially built skateparks back then. But it's difficult to understand why they were so looked down on because I'm sure they didn't mean to get in the way of people and annoy them. It's completely different nowadays of course – you can practise in almost every city park.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*Question 3      You hear a girl talking about a diary she keeps.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: I've been writing a diary ever since my mother bought one for my seventh birthday, and I don't mean a book with dates for homework assignments and parties; for me it's more where I jot down my thoughts and feelings, and even sketch things that catch my eye. And I really appreciate being able to look back at what I've written. When I first began, I was worried my life was boring and there wouldn't be much to say, but it's actually made me realise that I do some quite cool stuff. Some people say writing a diary makes you remember the bad times. In fact, it's the opposite for me!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*Question 4      You hear a boy talking about a weekly video he posts online in which he expresses his opinions.*

[pause]

tone

Boy: I guess my videos have been a success, at least judging by the number of comments I get – sometimes there are so many I can't possibly answer them all. People who leave comments don't necessarily agree with every word I say and tell me why they think I'm wrong. I've learnt not to take this personally though. The thing is to get a discussion going if I can and arguing's part of that. There's a lot of pressure to come up with something new and fresh every week though, 'cos there are more people doing similar things to me, and it's important to keep everyone coming back for more.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 2 Key

Question 5      *You hear part of a programme about sea creatures called sea dragons.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Sea dragons may sound like mythical animals from a fairy tale, but they really do exist. They're amazing little creatures, close cousins of seahorses, and they feed off tiny fish and plankton. They don't have teeth or a stomach and, you know, they have to eat constantly, and they're able to travel quite long distances to find an adequate food supply. Until recently, scientists believed that there were only two species of sea dragon: the Leafy sea dragon, which has large plant like flaps flowing out of its body, and the Weedy sea dragon, which looks similar but has smaller flaps. It turns out there's a third type – one scientists have decided to call the Ruby sea dragon, thanks to its stunning colour.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6      *You hear two friends talking about a film they've seen.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: Well, that film was rather disappointing, wasn't it?

Boy: I quite enjoyed it actually. More than the book it was based on. I didn't even manage to finish that. At least I know how the story ended now.

Girl: Well, actually the film totally changed the ending to the story, and I couldn't really understand why. And also, the boy who played the lead wasn't like I'd imagined – a bit too self-confident, you know?

Boy: But what did you think of the soundtrack? I found it a bit annoying and repetitive at times.

Girl: It's not the sort of thing you'd normally associate with that type of film – it seemed to work though.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*Question 7*      *You hear a news item about a small town in Alaska called Whittier.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: Whittier is a port in the US state of Alaska. When you get there you realize that there's something quite unusual about it. There are no picturesque little homes scattered around. Almost the only building you can see is the Begich Tower. This 14-storey complex is home to the majority of Whittier's 200 residents.

As well as providing accommodation, the Tower also houses Whittier's police station, supermarket and local government office. The school, which caters for kids of all ages, isn't too far from the building's west tower and is accessible via an underground tunnel. This means they've no excuse not to go even during Whittier's extremely severe winters.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*Question 8*      *You hear two friends talking about a dance competition.*

[pause]

tone

Boy: Are you looking forward to the dance competition on Saturday?

Girl: Yes. Are you going to go in for it?

Boy: No way. I'll buy a ticket and go and watch, though. What about you?

Girl: I'm actually competing in it – I'll probably be a bit nervous so I expect you'll have a better time than me.

Boy: Well, I'm sure you'll be fine and the audience will love it. But the people in charge really should've put it off until everyone knew what they were doing.

Girl: I could've done with more time to learn my steps, that's for sure!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*That's the end of Part One.*

*Now turn to Part Two.*

[pause]

PART 2

*You'll hear an astronomer called Steve Mitchell talking about his work. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.*

*You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.*

[pause]

tone

Steve: Hi. I'm Steve Mitchell and I work as an astronomer. I've been invited here today to tell you about my work.

I became keen on astronomy when I was a kid. I read science magazines intended for adults – anything about maths and physics – I didn't fully understand them but I loved the challenge. I watched a lot of TV – I loved nature programmes and I was also interested in a documentary that was popular then – that's what opened my eyes to the possibility of astronomy as a career.

As a teenager I went stargazing whenever I could. I didn't understand the complexity of everything I saw in the night sky at that stage – it was the beauty of it which appealed to me. It's easy to get excited by the mystery of the universe – there's still so much we don't know about it.

Every night felt like an adventure – I used to stay up late hoping to catch a glimpse of another galaxy through my telescope or to see a shooting star – what astronomers call a meteor. I didn't manage to spot one, unfortunately. I saw my first comet when I was sixteen though – that was thrilling, even for my family who weren't into astronomy.

Then I started studying the wide range of stars in the universe. Their different colours reflect how old they are. Recently I've taken a particular interest in all the different moons out there. There are millions of them orbiting the planets and it's astonishing that some are intensely hot and have volcanoes on their surface while others have an icy surface with oceans underneath.

I've recently been to a research centre in the USA and met other astronomers, which was something I'd always wanted to do. I also attended the launch of a spacecraft bound for Mars, which was awesome. One day it might be possible to live on a base there and lots of young scientists dream of doing that. Visiting a space station is definitely on the list of things I hope to do. And there are a couple orbiting the Earth right now!

Now, if you're thinking of taking up astronomy, don't worry about equipment. A good beginners' telescope isn't as expensive as you'd imagine. The weather can spoil things at times – you don't see stars in a sky covered with clouds, and light pollution is becoming an issue in cities. It may mean you see nothing, even on a cloudless night, which is often something people don't realise when they're starting out.

To get started in astronomy, you can learn the basics from a website – there are plenty to choose from. But that means you don't get to meet people and share ideas. You could consider taking a course, but a good one can be expensive. Joining a club is another option, and if you've got one locally that'd be the ideal thing.

So what should you try to spot first? Well, the planet Saturn is fascinating with its rings round it, which are clearly visible with a telescope, so it'd be good to look out for them. Jupiter has remarkably colourful clouds surrounding it, but they're not so easily seen. Another feature of Jupiter is what's known as its red spot, which is actually a huge storm in its atmosphere, but even experts struggle to locate it.

Astronomy, at a professional level, requires specialist knowledge and skills. Astronomers need to make calculations, for example, about the distance between stars. But amateur astronomers have a real part to play – teenagers have made significant discoveries including new stars, and there are certainly more to be made. So it's a worthwhile hobby!

To be a professional astronomer, you'll need a passion for the subject. Curiosity matters too – the ability to keep asking questions. And astronomy's a competitive career – so you'll need ambition. More than anything else, though, discipline is what's needed because all scientists have to be prepared to work hard.

[pause]

*Now you'll hear Part Two again.*

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*That's the end of Part Two.*

*Now turn to Part Three.*

[pause]

PART 3

*You'll hear five short extracts in which teenagers are talking about a favourite book. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) what each speaker says about the book. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.*

*You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.*

[pause]

tone

**Speaker 1**

- Girl: My favourite book's called 'Think Twice'. It's quite an old-fashioned book in some ways, but that's partly why it appeals to me, and also because my grandmother gave it to me. She said she used to love it when she was my age and she was so pleased when she found a copy of it for me. I haven't read anything else by the same writer but I'd like to. She presents the characters to you in a fascinating way which really brings them to life – and once you get into the plot, it keeps you guessing right to the end. It was adapted for television recently and they did it much better than I'd expected. But I still prefer the book.

[pause]

**Speaker 2**

- Boy: I really love a book my brother gave me for my last birthday called 'Henry's Adventures'. He said the main character was just like me, which I think's a bit unfair because that guy, Henry, is always doing ridiculous things, getting into all sorts of trouble. The author's done a great job though, writing about the different places where Henry goes – I could almost see them! It's really hilarious – I just couldn't stop laughing, and I literally couldn't put the book down from the moment I picked it up. It'd make a great TV series. I've finished it now and I'm definitely going to read some other stuff by her.

[pause]

**Speaker 3**

- Girl: I read lots when I'm on family holidays. We go to my grandparents who live near the sea, and I love lying on the beach with a good book. I particularly like books about other kids. The best one I read last summer was about a girl and her brother who suddenly had to move to the other end of the country. I could relate to it because we were just about to go through the same thing, so reading the book was good preparation for that. I have to say that it took me a little while to get into it, but I'm really glad I kept going.

[pause]

**Speaker 4**

Boy: There's a great series on TV at the moment about a boy who travels into space. I'd read the book that the series is based on and loved it. It's a lot funnier than the TV version, but they're both good in different ways. The hero's so like a friend of mine that the story could've been written about him, even down to the way the writer describes his appearance. My cousin asked to borrow it when I was staying at his place on a family holiday. He read the first page and didn't seem to be able to put it down again until he'd finished the whole thing.

[pause]

**Speaker 5**

Girl: I like stories about characters I can relate to. My favourite book's about a girl who lived in Ancient Rome. Although she lived at a very different time from me, many of the experiences she had are like ones that I've had too. It's an old book – my grandmother's name's in the front with the date 1950. She must've been about my age when she read it and it's great to think of her getting as much out of it back then as I do now. I love it even though it's quite a serious book – actually the writer's other books are much funnier.

[pause]

*Now you'll hear Part Three again.*

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*That's the end of Part Three.*

*Now turn to Part Four.*

[pause]

PART 4

*You'll hear an interview with a man called Josh Reed, who teaches people how to climb trees. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).*

*You now have one minute to look at Part Four.*

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: Today Josh Reed, who runs courses teaching people to climb trees, will answer questions sent in by our listeners. But first Josh, how do people respond when you tell them what your job is?

Josh: They say things like: 'How can anyone do that?' It is a weird career choice, so I can understand why they don't believe anyone actually does it for a living. And it's certainly not the sort of work that would suit everyone.

Interviewer: Now, Ben, who's twelve, asks how old you were when you started climbing trees.

Josh: Well, I was about Ben's age actually. There were lots of trees where I lived, and I used to climb them after school. The world felt different from up there and it was an escape for me from all the homework and stuff I was expected to do. I began with the smaller trees, but soon progressed to the bigger, more difficult ones. I even climbed neighbours' trees. I'm sure my parents wouldn't have been very happy about that, but I just couldn't resist it.

Interviewer: Right. Chris, who's fifteen, asks if you've ever had any other jobs.

Josh: Well, I studied engineering at college, but there weren't many jobs in that field at the time. I saw an advert for an assistant tree surgeon, which involved making sure trees in parks and other public places were healthy and in good condition. So I went for the job and ended up doing it for fifteen years. I never had any formal qualifications, but I worked with people who knew a lot and passed their knowledge on to me. I should've given it up sooner than I did, though – I needed a new challenge.

Interviewer: That takes us to Elena's question: What made you want to start organising tree-climbing courses?

Josh: Well, working as a tree surgeon, you get to know a lot about things like different types of wood, how trees develop, and also their importance to us. It made me think about what we're doing to trees and nature generally. I reckoned if I encouraged people to climb trees, they might see the world from a different perspective and then become interested in protecting nature. Tree climbing makes you fit too, and I thought people might be attracted by that as well.

Interviewer: OK. Lucy asks if she could learn how to climb really tall trees.

Josh: There's lots of interest in them – like the Giant Redwoods which can be over a hundred metres high. With the safety equipment and methods, experts can get up them without injuring themselves. Their trunks tend to be quite plain, but there are birds, insects and small plants living at the top of them which, of course, people would like to get close to. But extremely tall trees are also extremely old and can be fragile, and they should be left alone as much as possible. There are plenty of others worth climbing.

Interviewer: Maria asks what sort of people you teach.

Josh: Well, the majority are just ordinary people. Actually, I've recently finished a course for some 15-year-olds. Teenagers sometimes get criticised for not paying attention to what instructors like me say. But this group were very attentive. Like younger people often do, they picked up the basic skills quite easily. The only real issue was when they climbed a tree with a huge ants' nest in it. Some of them got really worked up about that, but generally they were much more confident by the end.

Interviewer: Right. A final question from Peter. What are your plans for the future?

Josh: Actually, I'd like to continue to do interviews like this – they're a good way to get across the message about tree climbing. The gear we use is much better than it was and there are good techniques that can be passed on. Tree climbing doesn't have to be restricted to this country either. The idea that tree climbing is a good leisure activity to take up has plenty of potential in other places too, I'm sure.

Interviewer: OK Josh. Thanks very much.

[pause]

*Now you'll hear Part Four again.*

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

*That's the end of Part Four.*

*There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I'll remind you when there's one minute left, so that you are sure to finish in time.*

[Teacher, pause the recording here for five minutes. Remind students when they have one minute left.]

*That's the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.*